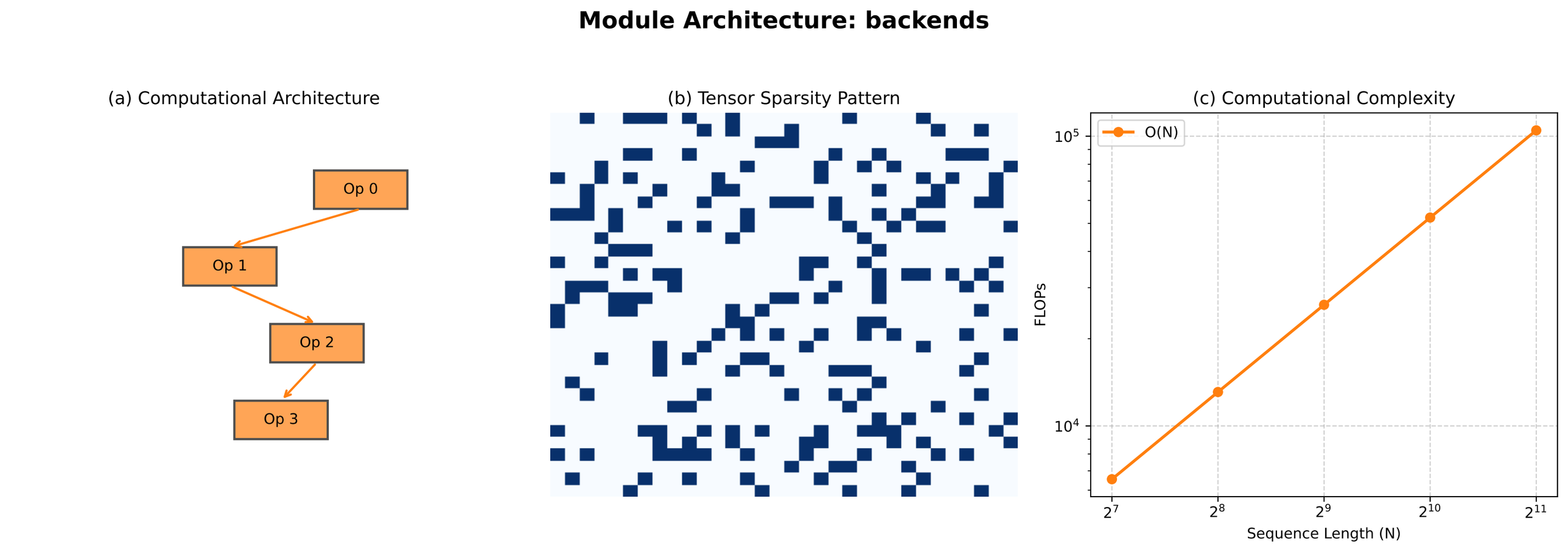Module Architecture: backends